



WILD EYEZ OUTFITTERS

PREP FOR HUNTING SUCCESS

WILDEYEZOUTFITTER'S CLIENT WESTERN HUNTING PREP MANUAL

WILD EYEZ

PREPARATION KNOWLEDGE EXPERIENCE SAFETY+ ETHICS = SUCCESS

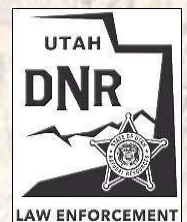
INTRODUCTION

[READ ALONG AUDIO =>](#)

“Preparation, Knowledge and Experience are the foundation of every Safe, Ethical, and successful hunt.”

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Read the explanations first so you understand how the hunt operates and why each category matters. Then use the checklists twice: once while gathering and testing your equipment, and again immediately before departure. The goal is not to own every possible item. The goal is to arrive with a complete system that you have already worn, carried, and practiced with.





~SEE THE WILD...



WELCOME

Hello, I'm Tyler Miller with Wild Eyes Outfitters. This Client Hunt Prep Manual provides a general packing list, preparation guide, and outline of what to expect during a big game hunt in Utah. It includes important safety information, equipment recommendations, clothing suggestions, and practical guidance for preparing for your hunt. If you received this manual, you may be considering a hunt with us, or you may have already booked your hunt with us. Either way, I want to thank you for considering Wild Eyez Outfitters and congratulate you on your upcoming hunting adventure.

The items in this manual are not brand specific. I may occasionally recommend a particular brand or explain whether an item is essential or optional. However, the final selection of clothing and equipment remains at your discretion. Utah's weather, terrain, elevation, and big game habitat vary greatly.

The information in this manual is based on knowledge of the local area, seasonal migration patterns, previous client hunts, and more than forty years of personal hunting and field experience.

WILD EYEZ OUTFITTERS FIELD STANDARD

This manual is built from field experience, not desk theory. Good preparation does not guarantee an animal, but it does stack the odds in your favor when the mountain finally gives you a chance. Client feedback repeatedly points to the same things we value guides who know elk, know the terrain, watch animals long before opening morning, stay honest about expectations, and work hard to create a hunt clients remember. The better your clothing, rifle, pack, body, and mind work together before the hunt, the more freedom your guides have to hunt aggressively, safely, and effectively when the moment changes.

SAFETY FIRST

PRIORITY NUMBER ONE IS YOUR SAFETY

Your Guide(s) and I will watch you closely, but we are VERY focused on the pursuit of your game animal, so it is your responsibility to know and watch yourself. We cannot see or feel the world through your eyes, and we operate at or near our own personal limits often when pursuing big game. We cannot be liable if you choose to exceed your own personal abilities and limitations. Reality is that you need to prepare appropriately or your opportunity for success will suffer.

***Conditions may become extreme in our hunting environment. Know your own personal limitations and follow all health practitioner advice that has been given to you above what your hunting guide may suggest or expect of you. Big game hunting is an extreme, adventurous sport. It is demanding both physically and mentally. Pursuing and taking a big game animal is an intense and rigorous activity.

Hunting is LETHAL by nature; something will likely die. We want that to be the game animal that is on your permit and not yourself, your guide, or any other unintended life.



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WHAT TO EXPECT

Expect travel methods to vary with weather, terrain, and access conditions. Depending on conditions, transportation may include:

- A heated 4x4 off-road hunting automobile, if conditions permit and it is the best choice for access.
- Snowmobiles when snow and weather require them.
- ATVs and side-by-side OHV where terrain and conditions allow.
- Equine travel when that is the most practical travel method for the area.
- Hiking, which is still the primary way we get where we need to go.

If you are uncomfortable with any method of travel, please let me know before your hunt so I can plan accordingly.

PROFESSIONAL POINTER

When conditions allow, plan to sleep or fully rest during the middle of the day. If midday hunting is productive, we may remain active, continue glassing, reposition, or continue the pursuit. When downtime is available, use it to reset your mind. The goal is to remain mentally sharp when the evening opportunity arrives.

A typical day will start around 5:00 a.m. We will develop a plan based on current big game animal location, weather conditions, hunting conditions, and past experience. A typical pursuit may include traveling to the intended hunt area, hiking from the access point to locate game, evaluating animals, making a stalk, and setting up for a shot when the opportunity is right.

WEATHER & TERRAIN

We may hunt pinon and juniper country at roughly 5,000 to 7,000 feet, or quaking aspen and blue spruce terrain from roughly 7,000 to 11,000 feet. Cover may range from semi-open to dense. Distance to your game can vary from close encounters inside 100 yards to long-range opportunities over 1,000 yards.

One suggestion is to carry a waterproof mat or similar pad which can be very quickly deployed to lay upon rather than directly in the dirt, mud or snow. However, it is not always possible to deploy this equipment before a shooting opportunity presents itself.



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CLOTHING & FOOTWEAR

Do not skimp on clothing. You may have only seconds to sit or lie in snow, gain your sight picture, and take the shot.

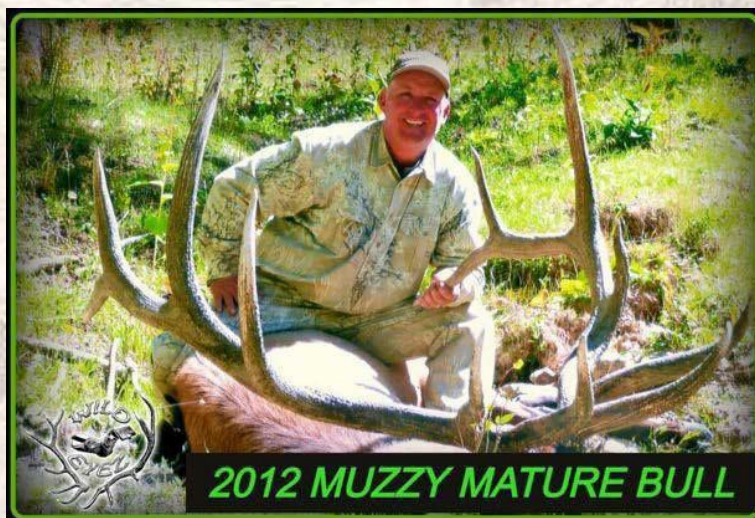
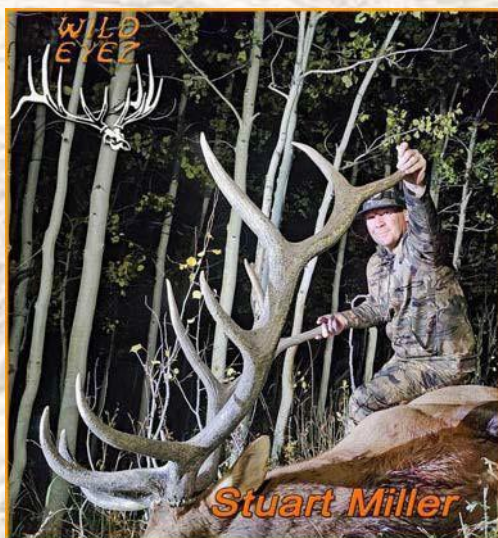
Think of your apparel as field gear. In a hunting environment, apparel does a lot more than simply keep you covered. Your apparel system needs to protect you, manage temperature, stay quiet, stay flexible, and help you perform when conditions change fast. Build it as a three-layer system so you can add, remove, and vent as needed. Your outer layer should be waterproof or highly water resistant.

BE READY WHEN THE OPPORTUNITY CHANGES

A careful stalk may give us time to study the animal, build a rest, and set up video equipment. Just as often, opportunity develops in seconds. You must be able to deploy your rifle, establish a stable rest, and prepare for the shot without learning your equipment in the moment. I will provide the range, but you must know your rifle well enough to make the proper distance and wind adjustment.

PROFESSIONAL FIELD TIP

When you are shopping for or packing apparel, put one hand into each sleeve or each pant leg and rub the fabric together the same way it will move on your body. If it makes excessive noise or sounds like stiff denim or heavy jeans legs rubbing together, put it back on the rack or in the drawer and find something quieter. In the field, noise matters. Wash all apparel once with baking soda and let it air dry. Do not use perfumed detergents or anything that leaves a strong scent.





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Review the clothing and footwear checklist carefully and make sure your three-layer apparel system is ready before departure.

UPPER BODY		LOWER BODY	
☐	Base layer: undershirt and thermal layer. These should be comfortable, quiet, and easy to move in.	☐	Base layer: long underwear or thermal layer.
☐	Middle layer: light and mid-weight shirt, light-weight vest, and a light jacket or hoodie to give you flexibility as temperatures change.	☐	Middle layer: joggers or light to mid-weight pants.
☐	Top / outer layer: mid-weight jacket and heavy-weight coat with a hood.	☐	Top / outer layer: mid-heavy weight pants with enough room to move comfortably.
☐	Additional waterproof or highly water-resistant outerwear for wet-weather conditions.	☐	Gaiters to keep dirt and snow out of your boots and off your lower legs.
☐	Gloves, warm hat or beanie, neck gaiter, and face protection appropriate for the season.	☐	Two pairs of socks, one light weight and one merino wool, or one good heavy-weight merino wool pair if your boots are high quality.
		☐	Waterproof boots with aggressive soles, already broken in before opening day.

PRO TIP - PROTECT YOUR FEET

Protect your feet before the hunt starts. Break in your boots before opening day, test your sock system on walks or hikes, and address hot spots immediately. A small blister on day one can become the reason you cannot hunt hard on day three. Your feet are part of your weapon system because they determine whether you can still get into position when the opportunity comes.

FIELD GEAR

Every item in your pack should solve a real field problem: navigation, water, warmth, communication, meat care, repair, or sustained energy. Pack deliberately and know exactly where essential items are located. Practice retrieving them while wearing your hunting clothing. That may sound elementary, but when adrenaline hits, familiar movements matter.

For hydration, I commonly use water mixed with an electrolyte drink, supported by high-carbohydrate foods the body can access quickly.



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FIELD GEAR CHECKLIST

	Hunting license, permit, identification, and any required hunter-safety documentation.
	Offline map, GPS or mapping app, and a backup compass or paper map.
	Satellite communicator, emergency locator, or other reliable backup communication option when cell service is limited.
	Headlamp plus extra batteries or a backup light. You may leave before daylight and return after dark.
	Compact first-aid and foot-care kit, including blister care, tape, pain reliever, and personal medications.
	Water bottle or bladder plus water treatment tablets, filter, or other backup water-purification method.
	Wind direction indicator, such as a wind puffer or lightweight indicator material.
	Binoculars, rangefinder, lens cloth, and any optics support you intend to use.
	Two sharp knives with a sharpening stone or similar sharpening device.
	Game bags. Preferably heavy canvas and not the netting type of game bags. Potato or burlap sacks are cheap and perfect.
	Four pairs of nitrile or latex gloves. They are optional, but handy to have for cleanup after quartering your game.
	Backpack or daypack with a bladder. Do not go cheap on a backpack.
	Baby wipes, sunscreen, lip balm, and any small personal comfort item you know you will actually use.
	Waterproof mat or similar quick-deploy pad.
	Lighter and matches. Vaseline-saturated cotton balls work well for starting a fire in difficult situations.
	Small repair kit: duct tape or gear tape, short length of paracord, flagging tape, extra boot laces, zip ties, and a compact multi-tool.
	Walking sticks or shooting sticks if desired, wrapped or silenced on the ends so they do not alert game when contacting rock or brush.
	High-carbohydrate food and fluids like candy bars, canned fruit, pudding, or sandwiches.



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FIREARMS & AMMUNITION

Bring the rifle you know best and are most comfortable operating under pressure. Arrive with enough ammunition for the hunt and for meaningful practice before arrival. Your scope should be checked, your rifle should be zeroed, and your ballistic information should be verified before you arrive.

Familiarity matters more than novelty. Opening morning is not the time to learn a new safety, turret, bipod, sling, or magazine system. Practice moving into position, establishing a solid rest, ranging, settling the rifle, and preparing for a shot smoothly.

AMMUNITION PREFERENCE

Lead ammunition is preferred. Copper ammunition is not preferred. I highly suggest .30 caliber or equivalent and a rifle system that you know well. It is your responsibility to understand your rifle's capabilities and ballistics. I will coach you through the actual shot, provide ranges, and operate as your spotter for follow-up shots.

PRIORITY SAFETY POINT

As hunting guides, we will often lead from the front or hunt from the front while locating game, evaluating terrain, and positioning the hunter for a possible shot. Because a guide may be forward of the hunter, Wild Eyez Outfitters applies a safety policy that goes above and beyond state law, rules, and regulations: no live round is to be chambered into the barrel until the target animal has been positively identified, the decision to take the shot has been made, and the shooting lane to the front is entirely clear.

THREE CONDITIONS MUST BE MET BEFORE CHAMBERING A LIVE ROUND

01 TARGET	02 DECISION	03 LANE CLEAR
The target animal has been positively identified.	The decision to take the shot has been made.	The shooting lane to the front is entirely clear.

This policy protects everyone involved. It is never compromised.



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PRESEASON PREPARATION

Your hunt begins before you travel to Utah. Wear your full clothing system, carry your loaded daypack, and practice realistic shooting positions. Pretend an animal has appeared and you have only seconds to move into an appropriate position, build a rest, control your breathing, and prepare for the shot.

PREPARATION CHECKLIST

	Confirm your rifle is zeroed before arrival and verify the ammunition you plan to hunt with.
	Try your clothing and gear on at home, wear it around, and assume all potential firing positions.
	Wear your hunting clothing, orange outer-layer vest and headgear if required, daypack, accessory equipment, and rifle on walks or hikes before your hunt.
	Develop scenarios such as spotting a game animal, conducting a short stalk, and deploying your weapon system quickly from an abnormal or inconvenient field position.
	Practice shooting uphill and downhill. Nothing is level in the mountains.

*****A wounded animal can occur, but it is an ugly thing. It is not taken lightly by our guides, and it weighs heavily on one's mind. We will go to extremes, short of risking safety, to recover an animal that is wounded at your hand.**

*****IF YOU WOUND TWO ANIMALS DURING YOUR HUNT THAT ARE UNRECOVERED GUIDE SERVICES ARE DISCONTINUED.**

FINAL REMINDERS

PRIORITY ITEMS

	Bring your hunting license, permit, required identification, and confirm the current Utah DWR guidebook and rules for your hunt before departure.
	Carry emergency contact information and any required prescription medications.
	Text Wild Eyez Outfitters first, when possible, since mountain service can be limited and I am often out of coverage locating your big game animal.
	Arrive physically prepared, mentally sharp, and with your clothing, gear, rifle, and pack working together.
	Use the checklists above before packing and again before departure.



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CLOSING

Thank you very much and again, congratulations on your upcoming hunt. Prepare yourself as best as possible and your likelihood of success will be high. We have prepared diligently for your hunt, are ready for your arrival, and look forward to making tracks with you on the mountain. This opportunity is a gift and an experience worth remembering for the rest of your life. You may arrive as a stranger, but our hope is that you leave as a friend.

Wild Eyez is Built from real mountain work, taught to us by our fathers, refined through real client hunts, and year-round time in the field.

Are you ready for the mountain?

Wild Eyez is ready for you...



YOUR OUTFITTER
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PREPARE
HUNT SAFETY
HUNT ETHICALLY
= SUCCESS

Preparation. Knowledge. Safety. Ethics. Success.

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